

How to Teach

Health promotion means giving people the skills and knowledge to take control of their own health. It works best as a conversation, not a lecture.

For health workers

Key messages

- Behaviour change is a process. It does not happen overnight.
- Use dialogue, not lectures. Ask questions, listen, and let people decide. Link the healthy behaviour to clear benefits for their lives.
- Listen actively. Sit at the same level, lean in, nod, do not interrupt, and repeat back what you heard. Ask open questions such as what makes this difficult for you.
- Help the person prepare and find supporters, choose one small step they can do, and say their commitment out loud, ideally in front of family and friends.

- Home visits: plan about 30 minutes, invite the whole household, do the conversation first and care afterwards, and keep it private. Visit new mothers, sick people and children not growing well first.
- Group dialogue: sit in a circle, agree ground rules, give everyone a turn, thank people who talk a lot and invite quieter people, and end with each person's commitment.
- Use pictures, posters and job aids from the NDoH. Speak slowly, clearly and in the local language.
- Follow up. Ask about their commitment on your next visit and celebrate progress.

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines. Based on the National Department of Health Village Health Assistant (VHA) training curriculum.